

greater match comes from the fact that we already have made substantial investments towards XMPP for real-time communication and are working towards tightly integrating the protocol into the heart of the platform. Since Google Wave is also based on XMPP, and is open source, you could expect to see Cyn.in implementing Wave some time in the near future, though it would be too early to discuss specifics."

The beginnings of the innovation

Cynapse, the company behind Cyn.in, has been in the business of providing collaboration and community solutions to medium and large enterprises for the last eight years. The company has also been a player in the evolving consumer Web applications front with products like SyncNotes. In its early years, it realised there was a huge gap between the evolution of consumer and enterprise technologies. "While the consumer applications (now called Web 2.0) evolved at a rapid pace towards empowering users with newer capabilities, enterprise applications focused purely at top-level business requirements, and failed to address the productivity and communication requirements of the users. As businesses become more and more knowledge-driven and deal with an ever-changing market ecosystem, real knowledge can be seldom successfully stored and communicated using structured databases and ERP applications," says Romasha.

She adds, "The real knowledge of the business is stored in the minds of its people and in the communications between them. Cyn.in was conceived to solve this. It aims to be the brain and the neural system for the modern enterprise, by connecting the people across the entire network of the business, i.e., partners, vendors, customers and not just its employees. Apurva Roy Choudhury (CEO, Cynapse) is the chief architect and inventor of Cyn.in along with Dhiraj Gupta (CTO) who heads the project."

Cyn.in is built on top of the Plone-Zope-Python platform. It is a layer over the famous Plone CMS, which is

highly-recommended for enterprises, and is known to be the most secure CMS out there. The company feels that the Plone and Zope communities have some of the smartest developers and technologists they have ever teamed up together, and a large number of them are really excited about where Cyn.in is taking Plone. Besides the Plone-Zope-Python platform, Cyn.in depends on and integrates various other open source projects such as the Apache Web server, the Ubuntu Linux server, the Ejabberd XMPP server, Adobe Flex and, soon Firefox and XUL. As well, to name a few. Cyn.in does not, however, integrate any existing point applications such as wikis or blogs; they are all created from ground up within the Cyn.in platform.

The product is dual licensed—under the GPLv3 and a commercial license for enterprises that may choose to stay away from open source licences.

The innovation angle

While most similar initiatives in the enterprise collaboration space have traditionally revolved around enhancing e-mail systems and others have focused on porting point solutions of the consumer space like blogging and wiki software, and gluing them together, Cyn.in has been designed from ground up as an enterprise collaboration platform. The uniqueness of Cyn.in comes from its design of free-form communication and collaboration, while providing for a strong focus on enterprise information security needs.

But why the open source model?

Cynapse is not a core free software company; yet, it released Cyn.in as free software. Why would any company do that? Romasha hits the nail on the head when she says, "Open source is not just our development model, but also our business model. Since the enterprise collaboration market is relatively new, the open source model helps our customers in their process of value discovery, and hence helps Cyn.in to achieve rapid adoption. Cyn.in deployments have already far



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